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Cacography

Cacography is bad spelling or bad handwriting. The term in the sense of "poor spelling, accentuation, and punctuation" is a semantic antonym to orthography,^[1] and in the sense of "poor handwriting" it is an etymological antonym to the word calligraphy: cacography is from Greek κακός (*kakos* "bad") and γραφή (*graphe* "writing").

Cacography is also deliberate comic misspelling, a type of humour similar to malapropism.^[2]^[3]

A common usage of cacography is to caricature illiterate speakers,^[4] as with eye dialect spelling. Others include the use to indicate that something was written by a child, to indirectly voice a cute or funny animal in a meme such as the captioned photo of a British shorthair that was the namesake of I Can Has Cheezburger?, or because the misspelling bears a humorous resemblance to a completely unrelated word.

See also

- Satirical misspelling
- Sensational spelling
- Catachresis
- Gaffe
- Corruption (linguistics)
- Eye dialect
- Teh
- Lolcat
- Tiopês

References

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